TORI HELEN COTTON

(she/they)

Curriculum Vitae

Logic and Philosophy of Science Department
University of California, Irvine
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Education

Ph.D., Logic and Philosophy of Science, University of California, Irvine — **Current**
Dissertation Title: "Understanding AI and Understanding With AI"
Committee: Cailin O'Connor (Advisor), James Owen Weatherall, Kenny Easwaran, Allison Koslow

M.A., Logic and Philosophy of Science, University of California, Irvine — **Jul 2026**

M.A., Philosophy, University of Arkansas — **Jul 2023**
Thesis Title: "On Neo-Humean Accounts for Natural Laws"
Committee: Barry Ward (Advisor), Eric Funkhouser, Thomas D. Senor

B.F.A., Studio Art (minor in Philosophy), University of Texas at Austin — **Dec 2019**
Magna Cum Laude

Areas of Specialty & Competence

AOS: Philosophy of AI; Feminist Philosophy; Epistemology; Philosophy of Science

AOC: Ethics; Logic; Philosophy of Language; Philosophy of Biology

Methods: Computational Text Analysis; Natural Language Processing; Data Science; Mathematical Modeling

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Articles

A2. "The Problem With Who I Know: What Contextualism Can Tell Us About Interpersonal Knowledge Claims," *Southwest Philosophy Review*, Jul 2023.

A1. "On Draper's Hypothesis of Indifference," *SHERM Journal*, Jul 2023.

Public Writing

P2. "Being Believed Isn't Always Enough," *The Prindle Post*, Oct 2026.

P1. "Why the New Surveillance Doesn't Feel Like Surveillance at All," *The Prindle Post*, Aug 2026.

Book Reviews

R1. "Review of *Philosophy of Computing: Themes from IACAP 2019*," *Philosophy of Science Association Newsletter*, Jun 2024.

Current Projects

Under Review

U1. "Digital Dirty Laundry: Conversational AI and the Epistemic Value of Unguarded Data."

Work In Progress

W5. "Using Word Embeddings to Study Scientific Metaphor."

W4. "Black Box Gaslighting? You're Imagining Things."

W3. "Computing Gendered Pain."

W2. "Fairness, Algorithmic Monoculture, and Randomization," (with James Owen Weatherall, Cailin O'Connor, and Kathleen Creel).

W1. "Headlines and Hashtags: Climate News and Online Engagement."

Presentations

Invited Talks

V1. "Digital Dirty Laundry: Conversational AI and the Epistemic Value of Unguarded Data," *Epistemology of AI Conference*, UC Irvine and Chapman University, Feb 2026.

Refereed Talks

T4. "Fostering Research With Inference to the Best Explanation," *2022 Annual Meeting of the History and Philosophy of Science Division of the Mississippi Academy of Sciences*, Mississippi Academy of Sciences, Feb 2023.

T3. "Aristotle's Luck," *Beyond Free Will: Variety in Understanding of Choice, Luck, and Necessity*, Vilnius University, Jun 2022.

T2. "On Draper's Hypothesis of Indifference," *2nd Annual E-Conference on Atheism*, Global Center for Religious Research, Dec 2021 (Online).

T1. "Passion, Death, Acceptance: Buddhist Perspectives in the Philosophy of Emotion," *Marquette University Conference on the Philosophy of Death and Dying*, Marquette University, Apr 2021 (Online).

Invited Poster Presentations

D1. "Making Fairer Algorithmic Decisions: Monoculture, Diversity, and Randomization," *Engineering+ Society Institute on AI (ProperAI) Symposium*, UC Irvine, Sep 2026.

Poster Presentations

R1. "Scientific Metaphor and the Space Between Words: Using Word Embeddings to Study Gendered Metaphor in Reproductive Biology," *Philosophy of Science Association Biennial Meeting (Poster Session)*, San Diego, California, Nov 2026.

Comments Given

C2. Commentator for Alexander Klein, "James's Solution to the Measurement Problem: Automatism Case Study," *SoCal Pragmatism Forum*, UC Irvine, Oct 2024.

C1. Commentator for Devin Morse, "Communication and Liability," *Philosophy in the Ozarks*, University of Arkansas, Mar 2023.

Other Presentations

O7. "Fairness, Algorithmic Monoculture, and Randomization," Flash Talk, *Engineering+ Society Institute on AI (ProperAI) Symposium*, UC Irvine, Sep 2026.

O6. "Chatbots and Epistemic Standpoints," Flash Talk, *LPS Summer Development Program*, UC Irvine, Aug 2026.

O5. "What Can Machine Learning Tell Us About Bias and Change in Language?," Flash Talk, *Disinformation Summer Institute*, Bainbridge Island, WA June 2026.

O4. "Climate News, Online Discourse, and the Limits of NLP for Studying Online Behavior," Flash Talk, *LPS Summer Development Program*, UC Irvine, Aug 2024.

O3. "Headlines and Hashtags: Climate News and Online Engagement," Flash Talk, *Competitive Edge Research Symposium*, UC Irvine, Summer 2023.

O2. Interview on women's experiences in academic philosophy, *Fillosophie: Research Shortcut*, Département de philosophie, Université du Québec à Montréal, Nov 2020 (Online).

O1. "Wittgenstein Applied: The Language of Modern Politics," *Philosophy Dialogue Series*, Department of Philosophy, Texas State University, Oct 2020 (Online).

Service

University and Departmental Service

Founder and Organizer, *AI, Formalization, and Mathematics Working Group*, UC Irvine, Oct 2026–Ongoing

Graduate Representative, LPS, Sep 2026–Ongoing, UC Irvine

Department Librarian, LPS, Jul 2025–Ongoing, UC Irvine

Member, *Graduate Climate Committee*, LPS, Jan 2024–Ongoing, UC Irvine

Colloquium Chair, LPS, UC Irvine

- Erica Shumener, "Governing an Unruly World," May 8, 2026
- Sally Haslanger, "Social Systems and Their Micro, Meso, and Macro Interactions," Oct 2025
- Emily Sullivan, "Idealization Failure in Science," Nov 2024
- Una Stojnić, "Inquiry and Logical Form," May 2024

President, *Logoi Graduate Philosophy Club*, Aug 2022–May 2023, University of Arkansas

President, *Phi Sigma Tau, Delta Chapter*, Dec 2020–Aug 2021, Texas State University

Outreach

Volunteer, "Ask a First Gen Philosopher About Life!" discussion table, *First Gen Fest*, Center for Student Transitions and Success, UC Irvine, Nov 2026

Organizer, *The Hypatia Society for Graduate Women in Philosophy*, UC Irvine, Mar 2026–Ongoing

- Event Organizer, "Canvas & Conversation," May 2026

Co-Founder and Organizer, *Feminist Philosophy of Science Reading Group*, UC Irvine, Aug 2025–Ongoing

LPS Summer Development Program, UC Irvine

- Graduate Student Panelist, Aug 2024, 2025, and 2026

Graduate Representative, *DECADE (Diverse Educational Community and Doctoral Experience)*, UC Irvine, Sep 2025–Jun 2026

- Event Organizer, "Balance, Burnout, and Boundaries," Dec 2025

LPS Visit Weekend, UC Irvine

- Prospective Student Host, Feb 2024 and 2026
- Presenter, "What Does Graduate Student Research Look Like in LPS?," Feb 2026
- Presenter and Moderator, "Graduate Student Diversity and Community Panel," Feb 2026

Conferences and Events

Organizer and Referee, *UC Irvine LPS–DOP Joint Graduate Student Conference*, Apr 2027, UC Irvine

Organizer and Referee, *UC Irvine–UC Riverside Joint Conference*, Oct 2025, UC Irvine

Referee, *UC Irvine LPS–DOP Joint Graduate Student Conference*, Feb 2024, UC Irvine

Co-Founder, Organizer, and Referee, *Philosophy in the Ozarks Graduate Conference*, Mar 2023, University of Arkansas

Organizer and Referee, *24th Annual Texas State University Philosophy Student Symposium*, Apr 2021, Texas State University (Online)

Professional Service

Journal Referee: *Science Communication*, *New Media & Society*

Grants, Awards, and Recognition

Graduate Student Award for Outstanding Contributions to Inclusion, UC Irvine LPS, $1,000, 2026

Graduate Summer Research Award, UC Irvine LPS, $5,000 (2024) and $4,000 (2025)

Graduate Student Service Award, UC Irvine LPS, $150 (2024) and $200 (2026)

Eugene-Cota Robles Fellowship, UC Irvine School of Social Sciences, $34,000, 2023–2024

Competitive Edge Summer Funding, UC Irvine, $5,000, Summer 2023

Graduate-Professional Student Congress Travel Award, University of Arkansas, $500 each, 2022 and 2023

Master Student Travel Grant, University of Arkansas Department of Philosophy, $600 each, 2022 and 2023

Victor Holk Graduate Scholarship in Philosophy, Sustainability, and Creativity, Texas State University, $1,000, 2021

Scholastic Leadership Award, Austin Community College, 2019

Academic Employment

Instructor of Record

Making Modern Science, UC Irvine, Summer 2026

Intro to Ethics, University of Arkansas, Summer 2023

Intro to Logic, University of Arkansas, Fall 2022 and Spring 2023

Intro to Philosophy, University of Arkansas, Summer 2022

Teaching Assistant

Honors: Naturalized Epistemology, UC Irvine, Fall 2024 and 2026

Race, Sex, and Science, UC Irvine, Winter 2026

Critical Reasoning, UC Irvine, Fall 2025

Honors: The Good Life, UC Irvine, Spring 2025

Honors: Critical Issues in the Social Sciences, UC Irvine, Winter 2025

Intro to Philosophy, University of Arkansas, Fall 2021 and Spring 2022

Research

Graduate Student Researcher, ProperAI Institute, Samueli School of Engineering, UC Irvine, Spring 2026

- Graduate researcher on the ProperAI-funded seed project "Fairness, Algorithmic Monoculture, and Randomization," with James Owen Weatherall (LPS) and Yanning Shen (EECS).

Graduate Research Assistant for Bob Fischer, Department of Philosophy, Texas State University, Fall 2020–Summer 2021

- Research support for *Animal Ethics: A Contemporary Introduction* (Routledge) and *A 21st Century Ethical Toolbox*, 5th ed. (OUP), as well as related journal articles, including interdisciplinary literature review across biology and environmental science, citation development, indexing, and background research.

Writing and Editing

Staff Writer, *The Prindle Post*, The Prindle Institute for Ethics, DePauw University, Fall 2026–Spring 2027

Workshops and Professional Development

AAAS SciLine Media Training Workshop, Philosophy of Science Association, San Diego, CA, Nov 2026

Disinformation Summer Institute, Bainbridge Island, WA, Jun 2026

TA Professional Development Program, UC Irvine, Irvine, CA, Sep 2023

Competitive Edge Summer Research Program, UC Irvine, Irvine, CA, Aug 2023

Quality Matters: Designing Your Online Course Workshop, Online, May 2021

Student Supervision

Informal Advising

Yuki Inayoshi (MA, University of Arkansas, 2026) *Jessimi Lyu* (High School, 2026), *Keilah Park* (High School, 2023)

Affiliations

ProperAI Institute, Samueli School of Engineering, UC Irvine, Fall 2025–Ongoing

Philosophy of Science Association

Last updated: October 26, 2026